

The second part of Phase 5 (Phase 5.5) explicitly teaches sound families. Sound families are formed from words that have common phonemes (for example /ai/) but different graphemes (for example ai ay a-e). Children will advance spelling skills by understanding the different alternative graphemes behind phonemes, their commonalities and their positions in words.

Children entering Phase 5.5 are able to read and spell words with a range of graphemes and have learnt numerous Common Exception Words.

The purpose of this phase is for children to link their knowledge of graphemes and phonemes as well as Common Exception Words. Spelling patterns are observed based on target phonemes. Knowledge extends into reading, providing options for phonemes when decoding complex words or what were previously considered Common Exception Words. Importantly, this knowledge can be applied to writing and dictionary skills when learning to spell new words.

Decodable readers at Phase 5.5 focus on the target phoneme. The target phoneme is shown to be represented by multiple graphemes and embedded into decodable text so that children can practice decoding words containing the alternative spellings. This allows for the spellings of sound families to be applied within real text.

Sound Progression

Phase 5.5 – Sound Families

/ai/	/ee/	/igh/	/oa/	/oo/	/y-oo/
/r/	/n/	/m/	/ch/	/k/	/sh/
/j/	/v/	/u/	/e/	/i/	/s/
/zh/ /z/	/ar/	/or/	/ur/	/air/	/ear/